

Dmitri Mendeleev

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By the way...
I was nominated for the Nobel Prize in Chemistry in 1906, but I didn't get it because my discovery was too old by then.

Elementary student

Born in 1834 in Tobolsk, Russia, Mendeleev studied science in St. Petersburg and became a **professor of chemistry**. As a teacher, he thought that if he could organize the chemical elements, it would **help his students** to understand them. This was a difficult task, and he spent years trying to figure out how to do it.

Atomic number is the total number of protons (positively charged particles) in the nucleus

Chemical symbol is shorthand for the element

Name of the periodic element

Atomic mass gives the number of protons and neutrons (particles without an electric charge) in the nucleus

He couldn't have done it without...

The Greek philosopher **DEMOCRITUS** (460–370 BCE) suggested that everything was made up of atoms, which means “indivisible” in Greek.

ROBERT BOYLE (1627–1691) was an Irish chemist who was able to prove that gases are made up of widely spaced, moving atoms.

PERIODIC TABLE

- The vertical columns are called groups, which contain elements with similar properties.

Each family is
a different color.

The horizontal rows (periods) correspond with the number of electrons (negatively charged particles) that orbit the nucleus. So, hydrogen in row 1 has one electron and barium in row 6 has six.